

CHORD

1. Passage anchor

> “That line really struck a **chord** with me.”

Passage meaning

strike a chord with someone = make someone feel a strong sense of emotional recognition, agreement, or personal connection

引起某人的共鳴；打動某人；讓某人很有感觸

Here, the sister's words connect strongly with the speaker's own feelings about entering a new stage of life.

Practice

1. Her story really **struck a chord with me**.

她的故事真的**引起了我的共鳴**。

2. The message **struck a chord with many young people**.

那個訊息**打動了很多年輕人**。

Core meanings of CHORD

2. chord — group of musical notes

= two or more musical notes played or sung together, usually creating harmony

和弦

Examples

1. He played a simple **chord** on the piano.

他在鋼琴上彈出一個簡單的**和弦**。

2. The song begins with a minor **chord**.

這首歌以一個小調**和弦**開始。

This is the central everyday meaning.

3. play a chord

= play several notes together as one harmonic unit

****彈 / 奏出和弦****

Examples

1. She ****played a chord**** on the guitar.

她在吉他上****彈了一個和弦****。

2. He learned how to ****play basic chords****.

他學會了****彈基本和弦****。

4. major chord / minor chord

= chord with a major or minor quality

****大和弦 ; 小和弦****

Examples

1. The song moves from a ****major chord**** to a minor one.

這首歌從****大和弦****轉到小和弦。

2. A ****minor chord**** can sound darker or sadder.

****小和弦****有時會聽起來較陰沉或悲傷。

Figurative emotional resonance

5. strike a chord

= create emotional resonance or recognition

****引起共鳴 ; 打動人****

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. The film ****struck a chord**** with audiences.

那部電影****引起了觀眾的共鳴****。

2. His comments ****struck a chord**** with me.

他的話****很打動我****。

6. strike a chord with someone

= remind someone of their own feelings, experience, or beliefs in a meaningful way

****使某人產生共鳴；觸動某人****

Examples

1. Her description of uncertainty ****struck a chord with me****.

她對不確定感的描述****引起了我的共鳴****。

2. The campaign message ****struck a chord with parents****.

那個宣傳訊息****打動了很多家長****。

7. touch a chord

Less common variant:

= affect someone emotionally

****觸動心弦；引起共鳴****

Examples

1. The story ****touched a chord**** in many readers.

那個故事****觸動了許多讀者的心弦****。

2. Her words ****touched a chord**** with the audience.

她的話****引起了觀眾的共鳴****。

****Strike a chord**** is much more common.

Geometry

8. chord — line segment across a circle/curve

In geometry:

= straight line segment joining two points on a curve, especially a circle

****弦****

Examples

1. A diameter is a special kind of **chord**.

直徑是一種特殊的**弦**。

2. The **chord** joins two points on the circle.

這條**弦**連接圓上的兩個點。

Distinct mathematical sense.

9. chord of a circle

= line segment connecting two points on the circumference

圓的弦

Examples

1. Draw a **chord of the circle**.

畫出這個圓的一條**弦**。

2. Every diameter is a **chord**, but not every chord is a diameter.

每條直徑都是**弦**，但不是每條弦都是直徑。

Technical / engineering extension

10. chord — structural member

In engineering/aviation:

= main longitudinal member or straight reference length in a structure, wing, truss, etc.

弦材；翼弦；弦長

Examples

1. The wing **chord** was measured carefully.

機翼的**翼弦長**被仔細測量。

2. The truss has upper and lower **chords**.

桁架有上、下**弦材**。

Specialist but established.

Anatomy

11. vocal cords / vocal chords

The standard anatomical spelling is:

> **vocal cords**

= folds of tissue in the larynx that vibrate to produce sound

聲帶

Important note

vocal chords is a common misspelling.

Correct:

> **vocal cords**

Not:

> **vocal chords**

Examples

1. Singers need to protect their **vocal cords**.

歌手需要保護自己的**聲帶**。

2. The doctor examined her **vocal cords**.

醫生檢查了她的**聲帶**。

This is an important learner distinction because **cord** and **chord** sound the same.

Related forms

12. chordal

= relating to chords, especially in music

和弦的；和聲式的

Examples

1. The piece has a simple **chordal texture**.

這首樂曲有簡單的**和弦織體**。

2. The composer uses dense **chordal writing**.
作曲家使用密集的**和弦式寫法**。

More technical/music-specific.

13. chord progression

= sequence of chords in a piece of music
和弦進行

Examples

1. The song uses a simple **chord progression**.
這首歌使用簡單的**和弦進行**。
2. I like the **chord progression** in the chorus.
我喜歡副歌中的**和弦進行**。

Key contrasts

14. chord vs note

note
= single musical sound of a particular pitch
音符；單音

chord
= two or more notes sounded together
和弦

Compare:

> one **note**
> 一個音

> several notes forming a **chord**
> 幾個音一起形成和弦

15. chord vs harmony

****chord****

= specific combination of simultaneous notes

****和弦****

****harmony****

= broader relationship between simultaneous notes/chords

****和聲****

A chord is one building block of harmony.

16. chord vs melody

****melody****

= sequence of notes heard one after another

****旋律****

****chord****

= notes sounded together

****和弦****

Compare:

> melody

> 橫向的音符進行

> chord

> 同時發聲的一組音

17. chord vs cord

These are homophones but different words.

****chord****

= 和弦；幾何中的弦

****cord****

= 繩索；電線；某些解剖結構

Compare:

> musical ****chord****

> 音樂和弦

> electrical ****cord****

> 電線

> vocal ****cords****

> 聲帶

This distinction is extremely important.

18. strike a chord vs play a chord

****play a chord****

= literally perform a chord on an instrument

****彈奏和弦****

****strike a chord****

can be:

Literal

= sound a chord

****奏出和弦****

Figurative

= emotionally resonate

****引起共鳴****

The passage uses the figurative meaning.

19. chord vs diameter

In geometry:

****chord****

= any line segment joining two points on a circle

****diameter****

= chord that passes through the center

So:

> every diameter is a chord
> but not every chord is a diameter

Meaning map

The central musical concept of **chord** is:

several notes sounding together

From this develops the metaphor:

Music

strike a chord

→ **奏出和弦**

Emotion

strike a chord with someone

→ **在某人心中產生共鳴**

A separate mathematical branch is:

Geometry

chord of a circle

→ **圓的弦**

And a specialist engineering branch gives:

Engineering

wing/truss chord

→ **翼弦 / 弦材**

The passage uses the figurative emotional branch:

> **That line really struck a chord with me.**

> → **那句話真的引起了我的共鳴。**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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chord — music	兩個或以上音符同時發聲形成的和弦
play a chord	在樂器上彈 / 奏出一個和弦
major/minor chord	大和弦 / 小和弦
strike a chord — literal	奏出一個和弦
strike a chord — figurative	使人產生情感或經歷上的共鳴；打動人
strike a chord with someone	某件事與某人的感受、經歷或想法產生強烈共鳴
touch a chord	較少見：觸動某人的感情 / 心弦
chord — geometry	連接圓或曲線上兩點的線段；弦
chord of a circle	連接圓周上兩點的線段；圓的弦
chord — engineering	機翼、桁架等結構中的翼弦 / 弦材 / 弦長
chordal	與和弦或和聲結構有關的
chord progression	一連串依次出現的和弦；和弦進行
chord vs cord	chord = 和弦 / 幾何弦；cord = 繩 / 電線 / 聲帶等

Passage recap

> “That line really struck a ****chord**** with me.”

Here:

****chord**** appears inside the idiom:

> ****strike a chord with someone****

= ****to make someone feel a strong personal or emotional connection****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****引起共鳴****

* ****打動某人****

* ****觸動心弦****

Natural contextual translation:

****那句話真的引起了我的共鳴。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****strike a chord with someone****

= ****to strongly connect with someone's feelings, memories, experiences, or beliefs****

****引起共鳴；觸動心弦****

The metaphor is musical:

> a physical/musical ****chord****

> → several notes sounding together

and figuratively:

> an idea ****strikes a chord****

> → it “resonates” emotionally with the listener.

One final learner trap:

> ****chord****

> = 和弦

but:

> ****cord****

> = 繩、電線、聲帶中的「帶」

So ****vocal cords**** is correct; ****vocal chords**** is not.